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Project Management 101



Project management reflection

- Think about a past project....
- What went well?
- What didn't go well?
- What would you do differently next time?



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Reflect.

Share.

Poll question - What would you do differently next time?

What would you do differently next time?

Nobody has responded yet.

Hang tight! Responses are coming in.





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Project Management Overview

– Getting from point A to point B on time and on budget!

Scope (What is the goal?)

Plan (How will you get there?)

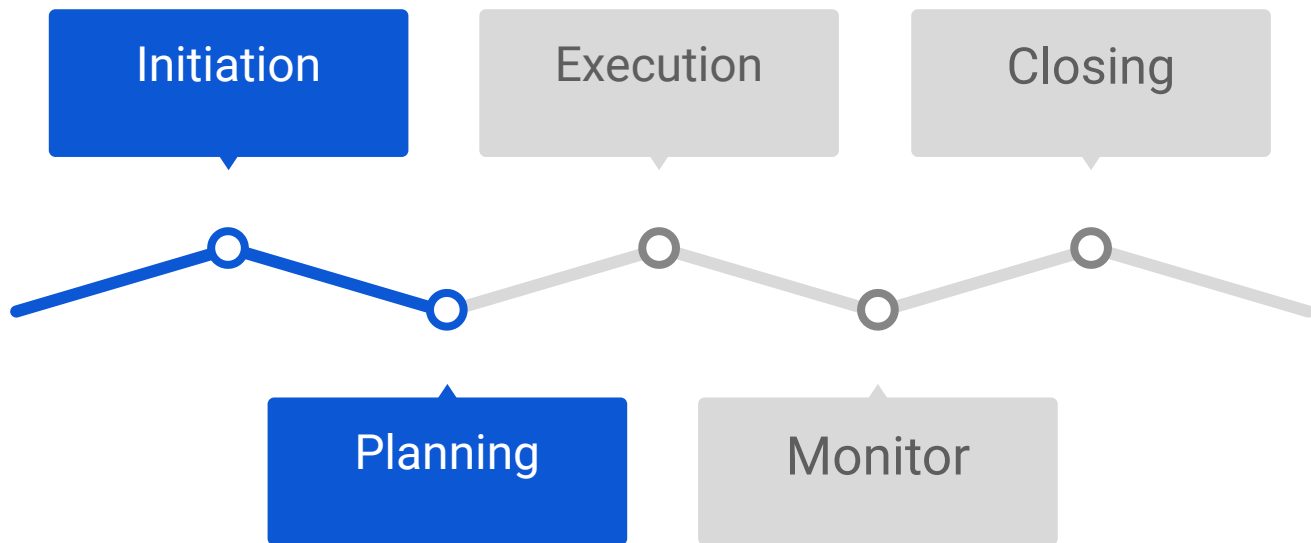
Engage (Understand roles, build relationships, effective communication)

Manage (Executing the plan)

Close (Wrap up and celebrate)

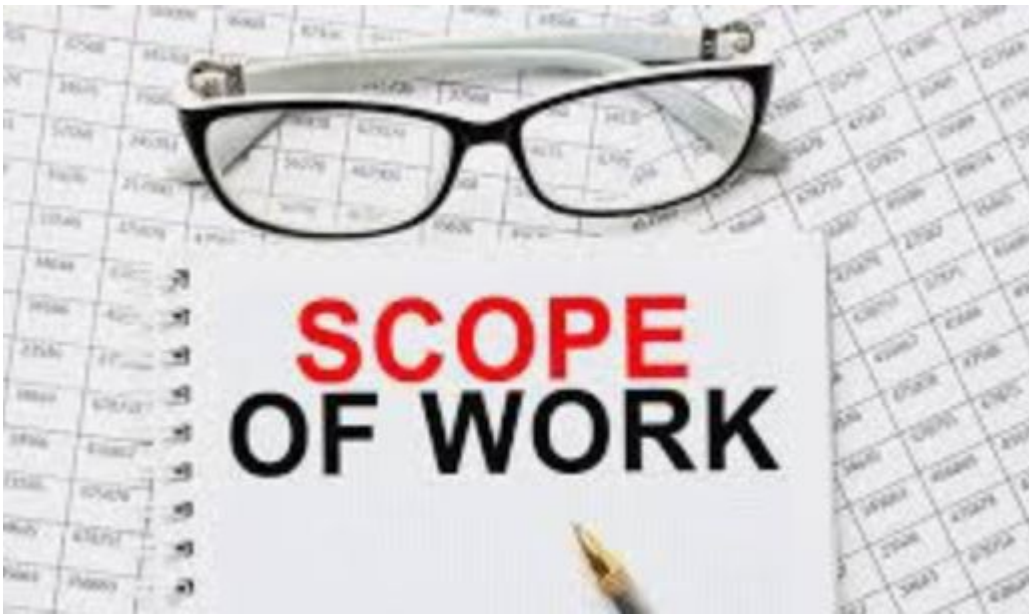


Typical Project Timeline





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Scope Overview

- Needs to include:
Deliverables, Timing,
Cost
- Results/outcomes of
the project
- Time frame
- DOCUMENT!





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Source: Knowledgehut



Common Problems with Scope

- Not enough time spent defining and reviewing requirements
- Stakeholders with different needs, priorities that were not brought in at the beginning of the process
- Poor, incomplete, ambiguous documentation. Relying too much on verbal communication.
- Inaccurate assumptions
- Poor communication practices
- Management turnover with point of contact, stakeholders, steering team members, etc.



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Project Plan

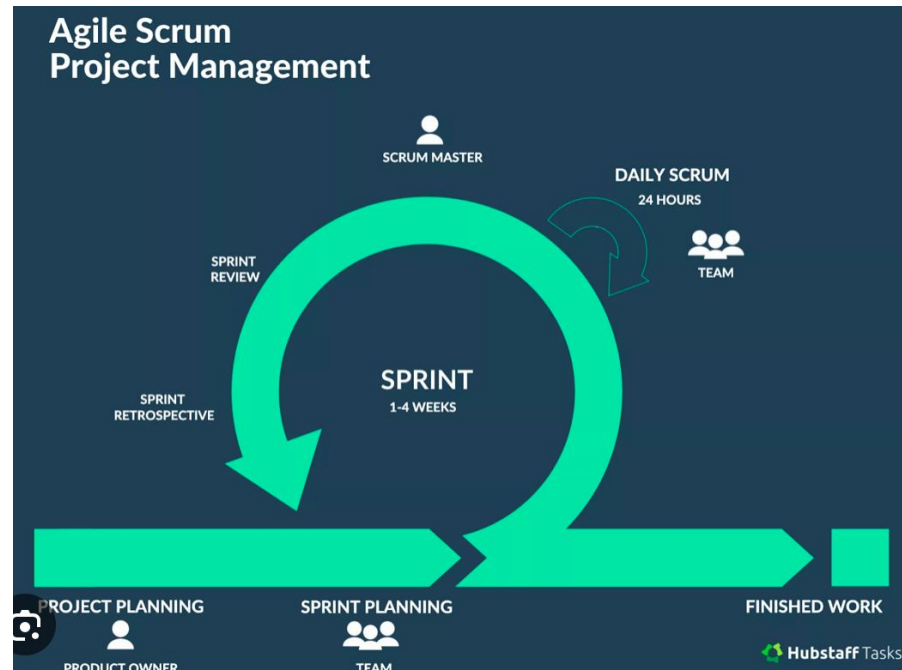
This is the roadmap that you will use to successfully complete the project

- What: Tasks
 - Work Breakdown Structure
 - Dependencies
 - Inputs/outputs/workstreams
- Who: Resources/team members
- When: Timeline



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Project Plan Example (high level)





Work Breakdown Structure

- How you breakdown the project into tasks during the planning process. (This is possibly the most important part of what you do during the planning phase of a project.)
- Defining work tasks in small pieces
 - By person
 - By date
 - By dependency
- Optimal task size
 - If a task is too big (You six people build a house in six months)
 - Hard to track and monitor
 - Miss opportunities to do corrective actions
 - Too small (Fred should paint one step in 5 minutes)
 - Spend too much time building the plan
 - Spend too much time providing reports
 - People feel micromanaged
 - Shouldn't exceed the check-in time frame

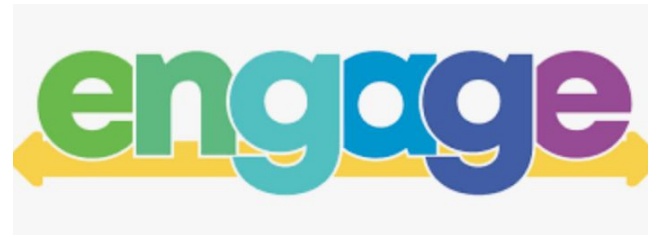


Common Planning Problems

- The beginning isn't really the beginning. (You are often behind on day one due to the time it takes to schedule meetings, finish up the contact, etc.)
- Vacations, meetings, multiple priorities.
- People are not responsive.
- Estimating is hard!
- Reviews and approvals take longer than expected.
- Scope changes that need to be re-worked.
- The end isn't really the end.....the client will have questions, will want changes, etc....



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Life (and business) is all about
relationships and communication.



Project Manager - role

- You harness the problem solving power of a diverse team – how do you ensure that the sum is greater than the parts?
- Keys to success
 - Understand and sell the vision – Motivate! Align!
 - Maximize the contribution of your team members – Understand skills, working styles, communication preferences.
 - Build effective relationships with your client and team
 - Manage up, manage down, manage across
 - Facilitate, coordinate, escalate!



Communication & Project Management

Whether it's in person or via email, with a sponsor or a stakeholder, effective communication serves as the very bedrock of business. It can sway public opinion, give teams a sense of purpose, persuade executives to increase funding—and boost project success rates.

Among those organizations considered highly effective communicators, 80 percent of projects meet original goals, versus only 52 percent at their minimally effective counterparts, according to PMI's Pulse of the ProfessionTM In-Depth Report: The Essential Role of Communications.¹ Highly effective communicators are also more likely to deliver projects on time (71 percent versus 37 percent) and within budget (76 percent versus 48 percent).



Communication Timeframe

- Beginning
 - Engage/Sell
 - Set the stage by sharing the vision
- Middle
 - Plan development
 - Status reports, keeps things moving along
 - Problem identification/resolution
- End
 - Final reports/presentations



Communication Formats

- Meetings
 - Good for bonding, brainstorming, decision making, rallying the troops, dealing with alignment/buy-in issues.
- Email
 - Professional, good for status reports, bundle, organized, tone, who to include, permanent record, CYA.
 - Highly efficient
- Calls
 - Good for issues, ambiguity, timely. When in doubt, pick up the phone.
- Formal presentations and reports



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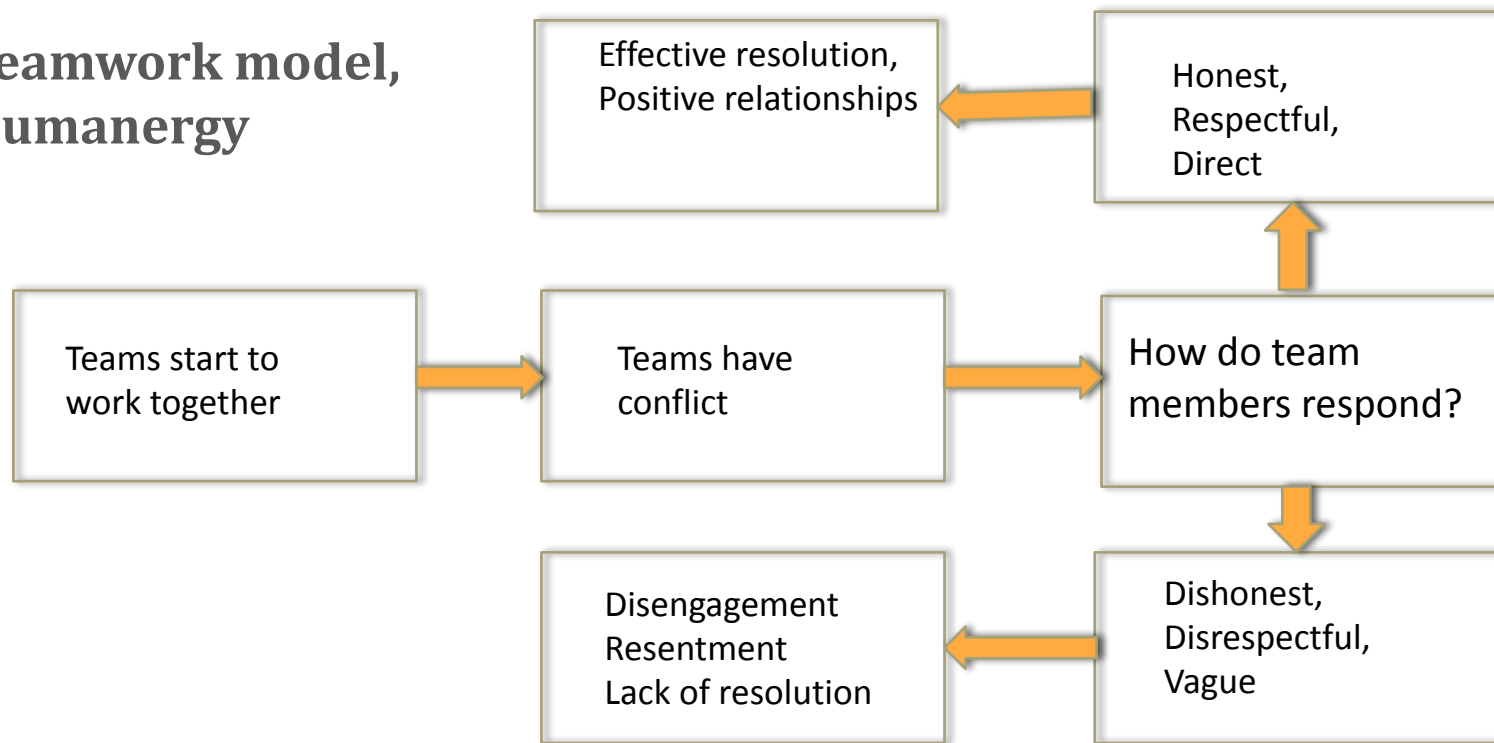


Team Building Stages (Based on Tuckman's Stages, 1965)

- Forming – Coming together, figuring out skills
- Storming – Developing effective communication strategies
- Norming – Clarification of roles, processes
- Performing – Highly engaged problem solving and output
- Adjourning – Debrief and celebrate



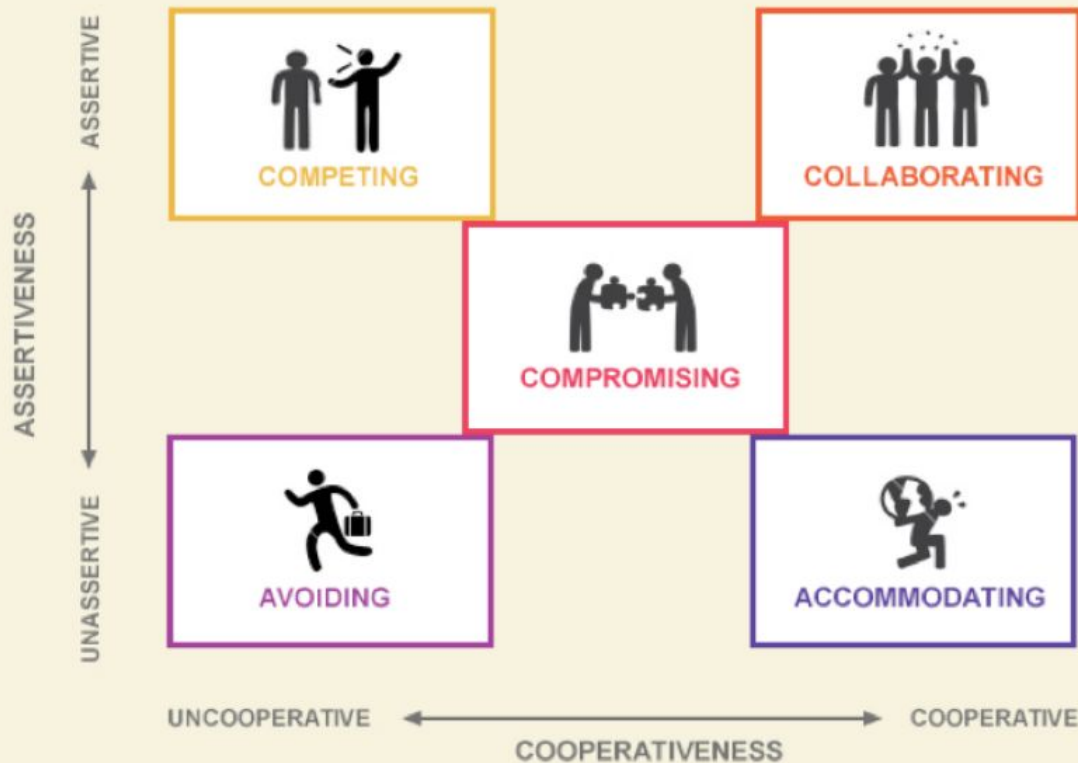
Teamwork model, Humanergy



Source: Humanergy



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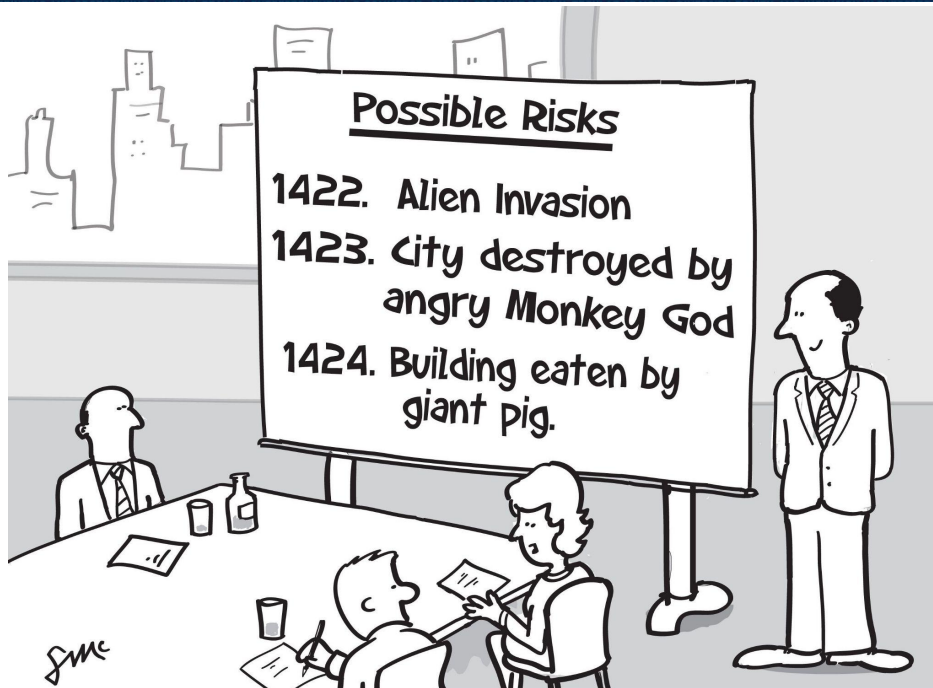


Source: <http://www.mspguide.org/tool/conflict-styles>



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"Well he certainly does a very thorough risk analysis."



Project Manager Role in Risk Management

Avoid problems from happening in the first place if at all possible.

- Identify risk:
 - Probability
 - Magnitude
- Have “early warning” systems in place.
- Always have plan B, C, D ready to go



Hazard analysis and risk assessment matrix with proposed actions

HAZARD SEVERITY

HAZARD LIKELIHOOD	Critical Illness or Injury	Severe Illness or Injury	Moderate Illness or Injury	Minor Impact	Negligible Impact
Very Likely	Requires Control	Requires Control	Requires Control	Manageable	Manageable
Likely	Requires Control	Requires Control	Manageable	Manageable and Tolerable	Tolerable
Possible	Requires Control	Manageable	Manageable and Tolerable	Tolerable	Acceptable
Unlikely	Manageable	Tolerable	Tolerable	Acceptable	Acceptable
Highly Unlikely	Tolerable	Acceptable	Acceptable	Acceptable	Acceptable

Risk Analysis

Source: <https://tms-outsource.com/blog/posts/risk-assessment-matrix/>



Risk Mitigation

- Remove requirements, decrease scope, increase budget, increase time
- Add resources, training
- Parallel process
- Build in redundancy
- Simplify (KISS)
- Extra milestones/checkpoints
- Head off politics & team issues
- Increase communication



Project Monitoring

- Key responsibility for the project manager after a project has launched.
- You need to know how things are going so that you can:
 - Make adjustments
 - Shift resources
 - Ring the alarm bell



Project management tools

Product Marketing Launch

Add task

creation stage

Approval

Content channel

Reference & planning

☐

Confirm launch date

Jan 15 - Jan 16

Complete

Yes

...

☐

Schedule kickoff meeting

Jan 15 - Jan 16

Complete

Yes

...

☐

Get launch targets

Jan 15 - Jan 16

Pending

No

...

Positioning & messaging

☐

Determine product & feature name

Jan 15 - Jan 16

Complete

Yes

...

☐

Write messaging and positioning brief

Jan 15 - Jan 16

Complete

No

...

PR

☐

Create press list

Jan 15 - Feb 1

Complete

No

Photo call

☐

Press outreach for launch

Feb 1 - Feb 8

Complete

No

Photo call

☐

Finalize press release

Feb 15 - Feb 28

Complete

No

Photo call

Video

☐

Update homepage

Jan 15 - Feb 27

Complete

No

Website

☐

Create new landing page

Pending

No

Website

☐

Update pricing page

Pending

Yes

Website

- Asana
- Trello
- Basecamp
- Smartsheet
- Slack
- Wrike
- MS Project



Metrics – the foundation for monitoring projects

- What gets measured gets done
- Balance between long-term and short-term
 - Stock options
 - Profit bonuses



Metrics should be.....

- SMART
 - Specific
 - Measurable
 - Achievable
 - Relevant
 - Time-based
- Included in the work plan so that it is very clear who should be accomplishing what by when



Metrics – Activity or Results?

- Activity metrics measure inputs, and can be easier to achieve than results
- Results are usually more important to the client, but can be difficult to guarantee as factors outside your control are at play
- Examples
 - Sales calls/sales made
 - Clicks/purchases
 - At-bats/RBIs
 - Hours studied/grades



Monitoring project performance

- Percentage completion – how complete is the project?
- Earned Value - Represents the amount of work that is actually completed

Example:

- For my class purposes, the project kicks off class 6, and is due class 12, thus there are six weeks. If the team is spreading the tasks evenly, the completion target would be:
 - After class 7, 17%
 - After class 8, 33%
 - After class 9, 50%
 - After class 10, 67%
 - After class 11, 83%
 - After class 12, 100%
- On a status report, show the % completion, and the target completion %, and indicate if your team is ahead, on schedule, or behind.



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You are working on a marketing strategy for your client. The project has been budgeted to take 100 hours.

Group members include:

- Abdul
- Brianna
- Chenmin
- Diego

Work Breakdown Structure -
Planned

Team Member	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Week 5
Abdul	Research Market 1 - 5 hours	Analyze Market 1 - 5 hours	Draft recommendati ons - 5 hours	Draft backgroun d - 5 hours	Compile report - 5 hours
Brianna	Research Market 2 - 5 hours	Analyze Market 2 - 5 hours	Draft recommendati ons - 5 hours	Video record industry expert - 5 hours	Presentati on setup - 5 hours
Chenmin	Research Market 3 - 5 hours	Analyze Market 3 - 5 hours	Draft recommendati ons - 5 hours	Create graphics - 10 hours	
Diego	Research Market 4 - 5 hours	Analyze Market 4 - 5 hours	Draft recommendati ons - 5 hours	Consolidat e recommen dations - 10 hours	

Source: Support.Workfront.com



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Team Member	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Week 5
Abdul	Research Market 1 - 5 hours	Analyze Market 1 - 5 hours	Draft recommendations - 5 hours	Draft background - 5 hours	Compile report - 5 hours
Brianna	Research Market 2 - 5 hours	Analyze Market 2 - 5 hours	Draft recommendations - 5 hours	Video record industry expert - 5 hours	Presentation setup - 5 hours
Chenmin	Research Market 3 - 5 hours	Analyze Market 3 - 5 hours	Draft recommendations - 5 hours	Create graphics - 10 hours	
Diego	Research Market 4 - 5 hours	Analyze Market 4 - 5 hours	Draft recommendations - 5 hours	Consolidate recommendations - 10 hours	

After week three, what is the target percentage of completion?

What is the actual percentage of completion?

What actions would you take as the project manager?

What is the target and actual percentages of completion?

45, 55

0%

60, 55

0%

55, 60

0%

60, 45

0%

None of the above

0%





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Close

- Client Considerations
- Team Considerations
- Personal Reflection
- Celebrate



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